

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Counting on a friend for help



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- When you have a problem, do you usually try to solve it alone or with someone's help?
- If you ask for help with a problem, is it better to ask a friend or a family member? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about social activities and decision-making.
- I can explain my opinions.
- I can speculate about things, people and events.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa offers to give Sally some **pointers***.

* A "pointer" is a piece of advice or a suggestion.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Hey, Sally! It's great to see you! It's been a while since we grabbed coffee.
- Sally:** Yes, I've missed our yak sessions and we haven't been out dancing for ages. I have something I really need to run by you.
- Vanessa:** Oh ... it sounds like you may have a decision to make.
- Sally:** Yeah, there's something I've been mulling over and I think you may be able to help me.
- Vanessa:** Well, I think I know you inside and out and I could definitely give you some pointers.
- Sally:** That's true. It seems like you know me really well. We spend a lot of time hanging out and I really value your opinion.
- Vanessa:** Wow! This sounds serious! You must be contemplating a big change.
- Sally:** It's something I've been thinking about and it could be really exciting for me.
- Vanessa:** I'm intrigued! And a bit alarmed. Tell me! What's going on?
- Sally:** Okay, I'll tell you what I'm considering and I think you could help me figure out if it's a good idea.
- Vanessa:** Okay, sounds good. We'll hash out the details together!
- Sally:** I feel like I can count on you to help me make this decision. But I need to ask you if you can keep my idea to yourself for now. I don't want anyone else to know until I've made my final decision.
- Vanessa:** Of course! I can keep a secret!





Let's Practice!

Sally gives her opinion about Vanessa's problems.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete them by underlining the correct answer.

1. You've been having too many family problems, I think / thought / can think you should rest and go out on the weekend.
2. You don't remember anything they said at the meeting; it thinks / seems / feel to me you slept through it.
3. When I was a kid, I used to thought / used to think / should have think that the best place to take a nap was at the park.
4. I know you are pretty determined to make that decision, but I felt / be feeling /feel you should give it a second thought.
5. When I was younger nothing seems / seemed / seeming to be a problem; everything would eventually be solved.



Let's Practice!

Sally speculates about some possibilities.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. when / her / broke / must / into / . / house / alarmed / been / someone / She / have

2. to / you / could / It / something / like / help / out / looks / me / figure / .

3. Sara / . / be / may / intrigued / the / conversation / by

4. risks / the / be / He / might / . / contemplating

5. mulling / . / decision / She / hard / must / be / over / that





Extension Activity

Write about a time that you were intimidated or nervous.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about a time in the past when you felt intimidated or nervous.
- Write a story about what happened.
- Exchange your story with another student and give your partner feedback.
- After you get feedback from your partner, rewrite your story.
- Read your story to your class or group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about social activities and decision-making.

☐ ☐

I explain my opinions.

☐ ☐

I speculate about things, people and events.

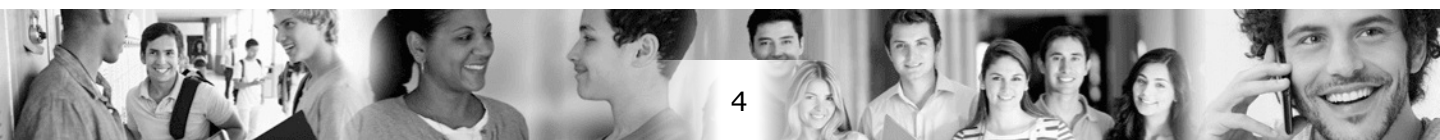
☐ ☐

I write a story, make corrections and read my story aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to run by** (verb): to inform someone about a situation so that they can give an opinion about it
e.g. I have something I really need to run by you.
- to mull over** (verb): to reflect about something over a period of time
e.g. There's something I've been mulling over and I think you may be able to help me.
- inside and out** (expression): to have a deep knowledge about something or someone
e.g. I think I know you inside and out and I could definitely give you some pointers.
- yak session** (noun): a chat or talk that takes a long period of time
e.g. I've missed our yak sessions and we haven't been out dancing for ages.
- to value** (verb): to consider something or someone is worthy and important
e.g. We spend a lot of time hanging out and I really value your opinion.
- to contemplate** (verb): to consider something as possible in the future
e.g. This sounds serious! You must be contemplating a big change.
- intrigued** (adjective): interested and wanting to know about something or someone
e.g. I'm intrigued! Tell me! What's going on?
- alarmed** (adjective): feeling frightened about a situation
e.g. I'm feeling a bit alarmed. Tell me! What's going on?
- to figure out** (verb): to solve or understand a situation
e.g. I think you could help me figure out if it's a good idea.
- to hash out** (verb): to discuss a plan in order to get to an agreement
e.g. We'll hash out the details together!





Learning Points

Explaining Your Opinions

When you explain your opinion, you use the Simple Present or the Simple Past. You can use verbs like *think*, or *seem* to express opinions.

To express opinions, you can use phrases like:

- *I think ...*
- *He seems ...*
- *It looks like ...*

Simple Present	Simple Past	Examples
<i>I think ...</i>	<i>I thought ...</i>	<i>I think I know you inside and out.</i> <i>I thought I knew you inside and out.</i>
<i>It seems like ...</i>	<i>It seemed like ...</i>	<i>It seems like you know me really well.</i> <i>It seemed like you knew me really well.</i>
<i>I feel like ...</i>	<i>I felt like ...</i>	<i>I feel like I can count on you to help me make this decision.</i> <i>I felt like I could count on you to help me make this decision.</i>





Learning Points

Modal Verbs for Speculating

When you speculate about something, you are making a guess based on what you know about the situation.

You can show you are speculating about something by using a modal, like *must*, *might*, *may* or *could*.

The modal verb is followed by the main verb in the base form. You do not use "to". Do not add "ing", "ed", or "s" to the verb.

Example:

*It **could be** really exciting for me.*

These are formal structures.

Examples:

- *It sounds like you may have a decision to make.*
- *I think you may be able to help me.*
- *You must be contemplating a big change.*
- *It could be really exciting for me.*
- *I think you could help me figure out if it's a good idea.*

